



Bruin Life



Bruin Life

HOME STUDENT LIFE ▾ OUT & ABOUT ▾ FOOD ARTS & ENTERTAINMENT ▾

CULTURE & LIFESTYLE SPORTS MULTIMEDIA ▾ YEARBOOKS ↶ STUDIO



ABOUT ▾ SUBSCRIBE



Image via Daily Bruin Archives





spots

written by Victoria Sitter | September 24, 2025

Starting college means one big question: Where and how do I eat? Luckily, UCLA offers a variety of meal plans to fit different lifestyles and appetites, so you won't have to worry about going hungry between classes.

Understanding meal plans and swipes

If you live on campus, you'll select a meal plan that fits your eating habits. UCLA offers several meal plan [options](#) providing a certain number of meal swipes per week or quarter. Meal swipes grant you access to dining halls, where you can enjoy full meals with plenty of options, as well as to-go orders from many other restaurants on campus.

Here's a quick rundown of the meal plans for on-campus residents:

- Regular Plans, or 19 Regular, 14 Regular or 11 Regular: These plans give you a fixed number of meals each week and if you don't use a meal during the week, it doesn't roll over to the next week. Also, you can only use one swipe per meal period — so one breakfast, one lunch and one dinner per day.
- Premier Plans, or 19 Premier, 14 Premier or 11 Premier: These plans are more flexible. You get a set number of meals each week and any unused meals carry over from week to week within that quarter. This means if you skip a meal one week, you can save it for later in the quarter — perfect if your schedule varies.

The number, 19, 14 or 11, indicates roughly how many meals you get per week:

- 19 meals per week means you can eat almost every meal on campus, including some weekend meals.
- 14 meals per week is ideal if you usually skip some meals or spend weekends away.
- 11 meals per week works well if you mostly eat one or two meals a day or don't eat on campus on weekends.

Dining on the Hill: What's where and what's good

Living on the Hill means you're surrounded by some of the best college dining in the country — seriously. UCLA consistently ranks at the top for campus food, and once you try it, you'll see why. There are two main types of places to eat: all-you-care-to-eat dining halls and grab-and-go boutique spots, and most are just steps from your dorm. For more information on each, including menus and hours, visit this [link](#).

The big three dining halls — Bruin Plate, De Neve, and Epicuria at Covell — offer buffet-style meals with rotating menus. Bruin Plate, also known as B-Plate, leans fresh and health-forward, with dishes like herb-roasted vegetables, whole grains and lean proteins. De Neve is a reliable comfort food stop, with pizza, pasta, chicken tenders and more.



For something more casual and customizable, UCLA's boutique dining spots on the Hill have you covered. All of locations accept meal swipes and offer mobile ordering through the UCLA app for added convenience. Here's a each spot and what they serve:

- Bruin Café, or B-Café: Think cozy vibes with made-to-order sandwiches, wraps and salads, plus soups that spot on chilly days. They also serve up a solid lineup of smoothies, specialty coffees and rotating dinner s with global flavors.
- Café 1919: Always will have you covered with paninis, mini pizzas, fresh salads and gelato. It's tucked into Terrace and perfect for when you want something warm, followed by a sweet treat.
- Rendezvous East: Your go-to for Asian-inspired takeout — sushi bowls, ramen, curry and boba drinks.
- Rendezvous West: Latin-style comfort food like burritos, tacos and burrito bowls, all customizable and ma Weekday specials keep things interesting, but the real star is the weekend steak quesadilla.
- The Drey: One of the newer spots on the Hill, the Drey is all about fresh, ready-to-eat meals — entrées, sa snacks that are easy to grab and go. They also have a wide drink selection, including agua frescas, coffee i
- The Study at Hedrick: A chill hangout for early mornings or low-key evenings. You can build your own sanc pizza or salad, and pick up snacks like parfaits, fruit cups and protein plates. In the mornings, there is a b sandwich option with a huge variety of pastries and baked goods.
- Feast at Rieber, or the Spice Kitchen: More than just a dining spot, the Spice Kitchen is a rotating, pop-up: experience that reimagines Asian dishes with a creative twist. Led by Chef Michael, it's perfect if you want something bold, flavorful and totally different from the usual.

Where to eat on campus

Even if you live on the Hill, chances are you'll need to grab food in between classes. UCLA offers a variety of din options all across campus — from cozy cafés and quick-service spots to full dining halls. Whether you're grabbi coffee between classes or sitting down for a meal, most locations accept BruinCard meal swipes, making it eas your meal plan wherever you go.

Some of the main hotspots are right in the heart of campus. The Bombshelter is a south campus staple with Bl Subway and Pete's Coffee — to name a few — and it's always buzzing with students on the go. Just up to centra campus, Ackerman Union houses a bunch of favorites like Epicuria at Ackerman, Wetzel's Pretzel, Panda Expres Jr. and Sambazon açai bowls. It's convenient for grabbing a meal between classes or meeting up with friends, b get crazy busy around midday.

Over on North Campus, there are even more dining places perfect for when those in-between lecture:  chi LuValle Commons is a hidden gem, offering Jimmy's coffee and pastries, Epazote Mexican Grill, Fusion, burger /



For a full list of restaurants, their menus and hours, check out [ASUCLA's Dining's official website](#) to plan your next meal with ease.

Making eating at UCLA work for you

With so many options available, finding your favorite spots and meal rhythm might take a little time, and that's okay! Whether you're fueling up for a big study session or grabbing a quick snack between classes, UCLA's diverse dining scene has something for every appetite and schedule. Don't hesitate to explore different dining halls and discover what fits your taste and lifestyle best.

Remember to keep an eye on your meal swipes so you can get the most out of your plan, and make use of mobile ordering options where available to save time. Your BruinCard is your key to convenient, delicious dining all across campus.

Welcome to UCLA — and happy eating!

—

Featured Image via Daily Bruin Archives

0 comments

5

—

VICTORIA SITTER

|

—

Victoria is a fourth-year biochem and psychobiology student and this year's Copy Chief for Bruin Life. Outside of editing, she's usually watching a movie, hanging with her friends or sending people hilarious amounts of Instagram reels.

previous post

How to beautify your dorm room: a guide to dorm living

A new Bruin's guide to finding the right room

YOU MAY ALSO LIKE





Bruin Life



An insider's guide to study spots
September 24, 2025

Free stuff at UCLA you will actually want...
September 24, 2025



Welcome to Westwc
September 24, 2025


FACEBOOK


TWITTER


INSTAGRAM